

Answer Keys, Rubrics & Next Steps

Everything you need to score Progress Test 1 (Class 13) and the Final Test (Class 26): answers and point values, acceptable alternatives, the errors to expect, CEFR-aligned speaking and writing rubrics, what the scores mean for each learner's next class, and how to give the news kindly.

Progress Test 1 /75

Final Test /100

Rubric bands: Not yet C1 • C1 • C1+

Confidential • teacher only

SCORING PRINCIPLES

Score meaning, not spelling, in Listening and Reading: an answer that shows understanding gets the point, even if it is misspelled ("the survary results"). In the one-word Use of English items and in Words & Phrases, the word must be right, because the word is what's being tested: *deteriorrate* earns the point (a spelling slip), but *get bad* does not. Circle items are right or wrong. **Rewrites** (Progress Test 3B) earn the point only when the target structure is correct; ignore small spelling slips elsewhere in the sentence. Writing and speaking use the checklists and rubrics below. Half points are not used. The tests use American English; **accept British forms everywhere** (the online lessons also use American English, but learners who studied British English may write *nominalisation*, *analyse*, *organise*, *colour*, *centre*, *programme*, *pavement*, *flat*, *enquire*, *Ms* without a period, *Yours sincerely*).

Three US/UK and register points to know. ① After a mandative trigger (*insist*, *recommend*, *It is essential that...*), Lesson 1.3 accepts **three** options: the subjunctive (*that he attend*, standard in American English), *should* + base (*that he should attend*, common in British English), and the indicative (*that he attends*, informal British). The tests reward the first two; the indicative is not an error in speech, but it earns no point in a rewrite that targets the subjunctive. ② *If I was you* is common in speech; don't penalize it in the interview, but *were* is required after inversion (*Were I...*). ③ Lesson 6.3 teaches the American sign-off *Sincerely*, and notes the British *Yours sincerely*. Accept *Sincerely*, *Yours sincerely*, *Kind regards*, *Best regards*.

AT A GLANCE

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Listening	10 items • 1 pt each • /10	7 note gaps + 2 lecture questions + 4 seminar functions + 2 prosody • /15
 Words & phrases	5 collocations/phrasal verbs + 5 connotation/register • /10	(tested inside Use of English)

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Grammar / Use of English	10 circle + 10 rewrites · /20	10 circle + 5 prepositions + 5 formal words + 5 concision · /25
 Reading	5 Yes/No/Doesn't say + 5 short answers · /10	Critical reading of an opinion column, 14 items (item 10 = 2 pts) · /15
 Writing	Formal recommendation, 4-part checklist · /10	Essay or report, writing rubric /15 × 2 · /30
 Speaking	Pair task, rubric 5 × 0-3 · /15	Individual interview, rubric 5 × 0-3 · /15
Total	/75 (written /60)	/100 (written /85)

PROGRESS TEST 1 · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /10

1	We may as well start without him.	/meɪəzwel/ runs together; <i>may well</i> has no /əz/
2	Had I known, I'd have called you.	the stressed opening <i>Had</i> is the clue
3	It was the price that worried us.	it-cleft: the focus comes early
4	Will you be using the car tonight?	the tactful future continuous (1.1)
5	ten years	"will have been serving... for ten years"
6	a third	"roughly a third"
7	b	"may well... a projection, not a promise"
8	Amara	"I'm not entirely convinced the timing is right"
9	b	litotes / understatement (3.3)

◆ PART 2 · WORDS & PHRASES /10

1	deeply	6	investigate
2	highly	7	thrifty
3	meet	8	self-assured
4	raise	9	postpone
5	put	10	notorious

Extra: *strongly* (A), the classic mistranslation trap: *strongly concerned* and *strongly unlikely* are not natural collocations (Lesson 4.2). Items 6 and 9 test the phrasal-vs-Latinate register pairs from Lesson 4.1; items 7, 8, and 10 test connotation from Lesson 4.2 (*notorious* = famous for bad reasons).

◆ PART 4 · READING /10

1	Yes	"anything urgent should be handled by message"
2	Yes	71 percent
3	No	"carried out by that company"

10	Both	Amara suggests it; Josh: "Agreed. Let's bring it up together."	
4	Doesn't say	clients are "left waiting", not lost	
5	No	"unlikely to suit every organization"	
6	The survey results: 71% finish complex tasks faster and evening emails have fallen.	either figure is enough; no point for "the policy"	
7	"It may well have done so" or "can hardly be considered conclusive"	either; copied accurately enough to recognize	
8	She thinks it doesn't really work for her team / she has serious doubts.	understatement; no point for "she is not sure yet" alone	
9	The complaints may be a small, visible part of a much bigger problem.	accept "there may be many more problems we can't see yet"	
10	b		

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR /20 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	will have been working	duration up to a future point (<i>by...</i> , <i>for ten years</i>) → future perfect continuous; <i>will be working</i> loses the "up to then" meaning	1.1
2	might as well	no better option (a decision), not a probability; <i>may well</i> is the false twin	1.2
3	used to have	<i>have a dog</i> is a state; habitual <i>would</i> works only for repeated actions	1.2
4	wear	mandative subjunctive: base form for every person, no -s, no <i>to</i>	1.3

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
5	had designed	<i>as if</i> + past perfect = unreal comparison about an earlier action (he didn't design it)	1.3
6	had taken	mixed conditional: past condition → present result (<i>I'd be living there now</i>)	2.1
7	in case	a precaution taken in advance, not a condition; <i>if</i> would mean "take it only when the battery is low"	2.1
8	does she make	fronted negative → question order with <i>do</i> -support; the main verb goes bare	2.2
9	was	what-cleft: <i>be</i> agrees with the time frame (a past event), not frozen as <i>is</i>	2.3
10	not	<i>hope</i> takes <i>not</i> ; "I don't hope so" is unnatural	3.2
11	had I seen such a well-organized conference.	auxiliary before subject. No point for <i>Never I had seen</i> or <i>Never did I have seen</i> .	2.2
12	you need any help, please call the front desk.	conditional inversion with <i>Should</i> ; the verb goes bare. No point for <i>Should you needed</i> / <i>Should you to need</i> .	2.2
13	her calm under pressure that impressed the panel.	it-cleft. Accept <i>which</i> . No point for ... <i>who impressed</i> (the focus is not a person) or a missing <i>that</i> clause.	2.3
14	we need (more than anything) is a clear timeline.	what-cleft with the focus at the end. No point for <i>What we need more than anything a clear timeline</i> (missing <i>is</i>).	2.3
15	expansion led to a reduction in its costs.	Accept <i>resulted in</i> / <i>brought about</i> / <i>caused a reduction in</i> , and <i>expansion reduced its costs</i> . No point for <i>expanding or expansion</i> .	3.1
16	your help, I would have missed the deadline.	<i>but for</i> + noun. No point for <i>But for you helped me...</i> (a clause).	2.1
17	was the demand that the website crashed.	<i>So</i> + adjective + <i>be</i> + subject. No point for <i>So great the demand was...</i>	2.2
18	attend the training.	Accept <i>should attend</i> (British register). No point for <i>attends</i> , <i>must attend</i> , <i>to attend</i> .	1.3
19	if / whether you could send me the file today.	past + continuous distancing. Accept <i>if you might be able to...</i> No point for <i>if could you send</i> (question order).	3.3

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
20	flexible hours may / might / can / tend to increase productivity.	one extra hedge is required. Accept ... <i>increase productivity in some contexts / to some extent</i> . No point if <i>proves</i> survives or nothing is added.	3.3

Lesson 3.2 (reference and ellipsis) is also tested in Reading 6; Lesson 3.3 (understatement) in Listening 9 and Reading 8; Module 4 lexis in Part 2 and Reading 9; the Lesson 4.3 register shift in the speaking task, Part 3.

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /10

- ◆ **Task & content 0–3.** 3 = purpose stated first, a clear recommendation, the other side acknowledged *and* answered, a formal close, 130–160 words; 2 = one element weak or missing (usually the answer to the other side); 1 = the recommendation is unclear or the text is under about 100 words; 0 = off task.
- ◆ **Organization & register 0–2.** 2 = logical paragraphs and a consistently formal register (no contractions, slang, or chatty asides); 1 = mostly formal with one or two slips (*Hi all, gonna, lots of*) or weak paragraphing; 0 = informal throughout.
- ◆ **Range 0–2.** 2 = at least **three** Modules 1–4 structures used naturally (a mandative subjunctive, a hedged claim, a mixed or inverted conditional or *provided that / unless / in case*, a cleft, a nominal phrase, diplomatic distancing); 1 = one or two; 0 = none.
- ◆ **Accuracy 0–3.** 3 = errors are rare and minor; 2 = occasional errors that never cause misunderstanding; 1 = frequent errors, but the recommendation is clear; 0 = meaning often lost.

Model answer (10/10, 152 words):

Dear Members of the Board,

I am writing to recommend that the monthly newsletter move to an email-only format from January.

The strongest argument is cost. Printing and postage currently account for almost a fifth of our communications budget, and an email version may well reach more members, since most now register online. It is essential, however, that no member be left out. I would therefore propose that printed copies remain available at the front desk for anyone who requests one.

Admittedly, some older members may find the change difficult. That said, were we to offer a short workshop on reading the newsletter by email, much of this concern would, I suspect, disappear. Provided that the front-desk copies continue, the risk of excluding anyone appears to be small.

Should you require any further information, I would be happy to attend the next meeting.

Sincerely,
Jordan Lee

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (PROGRESS TEST 1)

- ◆ **The false twins** *may well / may as well* (Listening 1, item 2) and **habitual** *would* with states ("I would have a dog", item 3). Both survive into C1 because they rarely block meaning. Recycle Lesson 1.2's "probability or decision?" test in warmers.

- ◆ **Third-person -s in the subjunctive** ("require that every visitor wears", items 4 and 18). Speakers of languages with a rich subjunctive (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian) often grasp the *idea* at once but still add the -s, because English marks the mood with an *absence*.
- ◆ **Symmetrical tenses in mixed conditionals** ("If I took... I'd be living", item 6; "I would have been a doctor now") and **in case used as if** (item 7). Recycle Lesson 2.1's "time each clause separately" routine.
- ◆ **Inversion slips**: double tense marking ("Rarely does she makes", item 8), a missing auxiliary ("Never I had seen", item 11), and **contracted negatives in inverted conditionals** ("Hadn't I known..."). Learners who produce inversion freely in speech often lose it on paper under time pressure, and vice versa.
- ◆ **Frozen is in what-clefts** ("What surprised everyone is how quickly...", item 9) and **over-nominalization** in rewrite 15 ("The expansion of the company's reduction..."). Praise the attempt; the fix is to put one working verb back.
- ◆ **Writing**: a recommendation buried in the last paragraph; an acknowledgment of the other side with no answer; and **register drift**, where the text opens formally and ends "Thanks a lot, see you!" At C1, a register slip costs more than a grammar slip, so name it clearly and kindly.

FINAL TEST · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /15

1	design	9	b (a digression)
2	night	10	b (building on)
3	7 / seven	11	e (disagreeing constructively)
4	trees	12	c (paraphrasing)
5	air	13	d (steering)
6	older	14	b (fall-rise = reservation)
7	20 / twenty	15	a (contrastive stress on <i>she</i>)
8	what can be done		

Extra letter in B: *a* (coming in politely). Items 1–7: accept any word with the same meaning that fits the notes (*planning* for 1, *elderly* or *old* for 6); accept symbols and abbreviations; ignore spelling. Item 3: accept "7°" but not "17" (a mishearing worth a quick follow-up on

◆ PART 2 · READING /15

1	The college should ban laptops from lectures (with exemptions for students who need them).	any sentence with "ban laptops in lectures"
2	Fact	checkable date
3	Opinion	"so-called", "nothing of the kind"
4	Fact	a checkable figure, even if it proves nothing
5	Opinion	a sweeping judgment dressed as fact

seven/seventeen stress). Item 8: "the one I care about most" is a **stance** signpost (Lesson 7.1). Items 14–15 test prosody from Lesson 7.2; if you read them without the marked intonation, don't score them.

6	false cause	scores fell <i>after</i> laptops, so laptops <i>caused</i> it
7	false dilemma	only two options offered
8	unsupported generalization	all students, no evidence
9	cherry-picking	mixed results, one study chosen
10	any two of: "depressing spectacle", "hunched over", "so-called", "every sensible educator knows", "nothing of the kind", "talks to the backs of their laptops"	2 pts (1 each)
11	concedes a point	
12	downplays the exceptions	
13	She thinks the idea is naive or unrealistic; she is dismissing it ironically.	accept "she doesn't take it seriously"
14	indignant and one-sided	

Extra term: *appeal to emotion*. Item 9: no point for *unsupported generalization*; the text itself signals the move ("dozens of studies... with mixed results, but one..."). Item 4 is the one many learners get wrong on purpose ("it's biased, so it's opinion"): a **fact** can be true and still be used to support a weak argument (Lesson 6.1).

◆ PART 3 • USE OF ENGLISH /25 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	will have fixed	completed before a future point; the <i>by the time</i> clause stays present (<i>arrive</i>)	1.1
2	will	<i>That'll be...</i> = a confident deduction about now	1.2

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
3	weren't	mixed conditional: a permanent trait now (<i>by nature</i>) → a past result	2.1
4	Should	tentative, polite condition; <i>Had / Were</i> don't fit a bare verb	2.2
5	did we realize	inversion after a fronted <i>Not until...</i>	2.2
6	that	formal register: <i>The reason... is that...; is because</i> is redundant in writing	2.3
7	Having finished	perfect participle: an earlier completed action, same subject	5.1
8	b	a and c dangle (the noise didn't walk into the room)	5.1
9	having run out	absolute clause with its own subject; <i>had run out</i> makes a comma splice	5.1
10	do so	formal substitution for a verb phrase	3.2
11	with	<i>comply with</i> (but <i>conform to</i>)	5.2
12	with	<i>consistent with</i>	5.2
13	in	<i>an increase in</i> the area; <i>of</i> only for the figure	5.2
14	On	<i>on behalf of</i>	5.2
15	event	<i>in the event of</i>	5.2
16	obtained	accept <i>acquired, collected, gathered</i> ; no point for <i>got, took</i>	5.3
17	demonstrate	accept <i>illustrate, indicate, reveal</i> and the -s forms (<i>data</i> is often singular in American English)	5.3
18	deteriorate	accept <i>worsen</i> ; no point for <i>get bad</i>	5.3
19	investigate	accept <i>examine</i> ; no point for <i>look at</i>	4.1 · 5.3
20	commence	accept <i>begin</i> (as in Lesson 5.3); no point for <i>kick off</i>	5.3
21	because	accept <i>since, as</i>	8.2
22	now	accept <i>currently</i>	8.2
23	decide	dig the verb out of the noun	8.2
24	can		8.2
25	crucial	accept <i>vital, essential, critical, key</i> ; no point for <i>very important</i> or <i>importantest</i>	8.2

Module 6 (critical reading, essay and report writing) is tested through Part 2 and Part 4. Module 7 (lectures, prosody, seminars) is tested through Part 1 and the interview. Lesson 8.1 (fluency strategies) and the Lesson 8.3 defense skills are tested through the interview's discussion stage.

◆ PART 4 • WRITING /30

Score the essay or report with the **writing rubric** below: five criteria $\times 0-3 = /15$, then **double it** (/30). Before scoring, check the length: under about 180 words caps *Task & content* at 1; over about 330 words, score only the first 300 or so and note it as a concision next step. For Option B, the report must use the survey figures; a report that invents data, or ignores the table, is capped at 1 for *Task & content*.

Model answer, Option A (C1+, 30/30, about 270 words)

Few workplace technologies have spread as quietly as monitoring software. Programs that log keystrokes, emails, and websites visited are now marketed as tools for "productivity insight," and many employers have adopted them without consulting their staff. While some oversight of company equipment is clearly legitimate, this essay will argue that continuous, detailed monitoring is justified only in narrow circumstances and that, as a general practice, it does more harm than good.

The strongest case for monitoring is security. Firms that handle medical or financial data have a duty to detect leaks, and in such settings limited, clearly disclosed monitoring may well be necessary. Few employees would object to measures that protect clients' information.

The difficulty arises when monitoring shifts from protecting data to measuring people. Keystroke counts reward visible activity rather than thoughtful work: an analyst who spends an hour thinking through a problem appears idle, while a colleague who sends thirty trivial emails appears productive. There is also some evidence that constant surveillance erodes trust, and staff who feel distrusted are, unsurprisingly, less likely to go beyond the minimum.

Admittedly, managers of remote teams argue that without such tools they cannot tell who is working. This concern is understandable, yet it overlooks a simpler solution: judging staff by the results they deliver rather than by the minutes they log.

On balance, then, monitoring can be justified where the risk is specific and the rules are transparent, but not as a substitute for management. Were employers to measure

Model answer, Option B (C1+, 30/30, about 235 words)

Report on Falling Attendance in Evening Classes

Introduction

This report sets out to identify the reasons for the recent fall in evening-class attendance at the Riverside Adult Learning Center and to recommend appropriate action. It is based on a survey of 120 learners carried out in October.

Findings

Average attendance has fallen from 85% last year to 64% this year. The most frequently reported reason was a clash with work: 58% of respondents stated that the 6–8 p.m. schedule conflicts with their shifts. In addition, 35% reported difficulty finding parking. By contrast, satisfaction with the teaching remains high, with 72% rating it good or excellent. Notably, 41% indicated that they would attend a Saturday-morning option.

Conclusions

The findings suggest that the decline is largely due to scheduling and access rather than to the quality of instruction. It would appear that many learners remain motivated but are unable to attend at the current times.

Recommendations

In light of these findings, it is recommended that a Saturday-morning section be introduced on a trial basis next term. It is also recommended that the center explore a parking arrangement with the neighboring library or provide clear information on public transportation. Finally, attendance should be reviewed at the end of the trial so that the effectiveness of these measures can be assessed.

outcomes instead of keystrokes, both productivity and trust would be likely to benefit.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (FINAL TEST)

- ◆ **Listening A:** sentences instead of keywords, so learners fall behind and miss items 5–7; and **the example remembered instead of the point** (writing "suburb" or "history" into the notes). Treat misses as a note-taking next step (Lesson 7.1), not a vocabulary problem.
- ◆ **Reading:** treating every biased-sounding sentence as "opinion" (item 4), naming the *topic* instead of the *claim* (item 1: "laptops in class"), and confusing *concede* with *refute*. Learners who agree with the writer often score the weaknesses lower: Lesson 6.1's "test the arguments you like" is the next step.
- ◆ **Use of English:** *The reason is because* (6), **dangling participles** (8; "Walking into the room, the noise..."), and the preposition near-misses *comply to*, *aware about*, *an increase of* (11, 13). Prepositions are the slowest C1 errors to fade; point learners to their Lesson 5.2 chunk list rather than to rules.
- ◆ **Over-formalizing** in Part C (*utilize* for *use* elsewhere in the paper) and, in the writing, **over-nominalized** sentences that lose the agent ("The implementation of the utilization of..."). Lesson 8.2's "is there a verb hiding in that noun?" is the fix.
- ◆ **Essay:** a thesis that announces a topic but takes no position; evidence dropped without explanation; a straw-man counter-argument; and **new points in the conclusion. Report:** "I think" and personal narrative instead of an objective tone, findings and conclusions mixed together, and vague recommendations ("the center should do something about parking").
- ◆ **Register drift** in both options: *sort of*, *a lot of*, *kind of* in formal writing, or a chatty rhetorical question in a report. Hedging that tips into mush ("it could possibly perhaps be argued that it may...") is the C1 version of the same problem.

SPEAKING RUBRIC · BOTH TESTS

Five criteria, each 0–3 (total /15). 0 = no response, or only L1. The bands follow the CEFR qualitative aspects of spoken language (range, accuracy, fluency, interaction, coherence, phonological control) and sociolinguistic appropriateness (register). The **C1** column paraphrases the Council of Europe's C1 descriptors (*CEFR Companion Volume*, 2020). For the progress test, judge against Modules 1–4 language only.

CRITERION	NOT YET C1 (1)	C1 (2)	C1+ STRONG (3)
Task & coherence /3	Solid B2: clear descriptions and a viewpoint with reasons, but a long turn is a sequence of points rather than a structure; conclusions are restated rather than drawn; the argument stiffens or collapses under push-back.	Gives clear, detailed descriptions of complex subjects, integrating sub-themes, developing particular points, and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion. Produces clear, smoothly flowing, well-structured speech with controlled use of organizational patterns, connectors, and cohesive devices.	A long turn that previews, develops, and lands its point with authority; qualifies and refines a position under challenge without losing its thread; the diplomatic message is gentle and unmistakably clear.
Range & register /3	A good B2 range, but relies on a few safe structures and general words (<i>good, big, important</i>); hedges are all-or-nothing (<i>maybe / definitely</i>); register shifts only in vocabulary, or not at all.	A broad range of language that lets them select a formulation to express themselves clearly in an appropriate style on general, academic, and professional topics without having to restrict what they want to say. Adjusts the level of formality appropriately; uses hedging and distancing to suit the situation.	Precise, flexible choice of structure and word for effect (inversion or a cleft at the right moment, calibrated modality, strong collocations and connotation); the whole register shifts as a set, including relaxed idiom and vague language where it fits.
Accuracy /3	Good control of B2 structures, but C1 forms (aspect, modal perfects, mixed conditionals, inversion) often break down in real time; errors are noticeable and not usually self-corrected.	Consistently maintains a high degree of grammatical accuracy; errors are rare, difficult to spot, and generally corrected when they do occur.	Complex structures are handled with ease even when the speaker's attention is on the argument; the few slips are corrected smoothly (<i>or rather...</i>) without breaking the flow.

CRITERION	NOT YET C1 (1)	C1 (2)	C1+ STRONG (3)
Interaction /3	Takes part and responds, but pushes back bluntly or concedes too readily; struggles to get the floor, keep it, or repair a misunderstanding without help.	Selects a suitable phrase from a readily available range of discourse functions to preface remarks, get the floor, or gain time and keep it while thinking. Relates their contribution skillfully to others'; acknowledges before challenging; paraphrases to check understanding.	Handles push-back with poise: concedes the fair point, holds the sound one, and steers toward a solution; asks probing follow-up questions; negotiates an alternative in the diplomatic task.
Pronunciation & fluency /3	Generally fluent on familiar topics, but long silent pauses when searching; flat or equal stress hides the key point; rising statements make claims sound unsure.	Expresses themselves fluently and spontaneously, almost effortlessly; only a conceptually difficult subject can hinder a natural, smooth flow. Varies intonation and places sentence stress correctly to express finer shades of meaning; lapses in stress or rhythm don't affect intelligibility.	Uses prosody deliberately: contrastive stress to correct or highlight, the fall-rise for polite reservation, thought groups that make a long turn easy to follow; fills any pause with a phrase, not silence. Accent has no effect on clarity.

WRITING RUBRIC · FINAL TEST PART 4

Five criteria, each 0–3 (/15), then $\times 2 = /30$. 0 = nothing written, or nothing in English. At C1 the learner can write clear, well-structured texts on complex subjects, underlining the relevant salient issues, expanding and supporting points of view at some length with subsidiary points, reasons, and relevant examples, and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion; they can also write clear, well-structured reports and select a style appropriate to the reader in mind (paraphrased from the CEFR). An assigned side is fine: score the argument, never the opinion.

CRITERION	NOT YET C1 (1)	C1 (2)	C1+ STRONG (3)
Task & content /3	Under about 180 words, or a topic described rather than argued; the report ignores or invents data; points asserted without support.	Essay: a specific, arguable thesis; each body paragraph develops one point with evidence and explanation; a real counter-argument acknowledged and rebutted. Report: the key figures selected and interpreted accurately; conclusions follow from findings; recommendations are specific and actionable.	The strongest objection steel-manned and answered convincingly (essay); patterns and the most important contrast in the data highlighted, not just listed (report); the conclusion or recommendations leave the reader with a clear, earned "so what".

CRITERION	NOT YET C1 (1)	C1 (2)	C1+ STRONG (3)
Organization & cohesion /3	Paragraphs without clear topic sentences; connectors repeated or mismatched to the logic; the report lacks headings or mixes findings with opinions.	Clear architecture (hook → context → thesis; PEEL paragraphs; restate → synthesize → implication, or report headings in order); signposting matched to the logic; reference and summary nouns (<i>this trend, such measures</i>) link ideas across paragraphs.	Topic sentences alone would summarize the argument; cohesion is achieved as much through reference, substitution, and given-before-new ordering as through connectors; nothing is signposted that doesn't need it.
Range /3	General vocabulary (<i>good, big, a lot of, show</i>) and a narrow set of B2 structures; phrasal verbs where the genre wants a formal equivalent.	Precise academic and formal vocabulary (<i>obtain, significant, deteriorate</i>), accurate collocations and dependent prepositions, and several C1 structures (nominal phrases, participle clauses, a mixed or inverted conditional, a cleft, the subjunctive in recommendations).	Structures and words chosen for effect and used sparingly (one well-placed inversion, not three); nominalization balanced with strong verbs, so the prose stays clear.
Accuracy /3	Frequent errors that make the reader stop and reread; dangling participles or preposition errors in several places.	A high degree of grammatical accuracy; errors are occasional, minor, and never cause misunderstanding; punctuation of complex sentences mostly correct.	Errors are rare and hard to spot; long sentences and punctuation are fully under control.
Register & tone /3	Conversational features in a formal text (<i>sort of, gonna</i> , chatty questions), or stiff over-formality (<i>utilize, endeavor, commence</i> everywhere); claims either over-stated ("this proves") or hedged into mush.	A consistent academic (essay) or objective, impersonal (report) register; claims hedged to match the evidence; concise, without padding or empty intensifiers.	Confident and measured: strong where the evidence is strong, cautious where it isn't; the writer's stance is clear without being loaded; every sentence earns its place.

WHAT THE SCORES MEAN

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 (/75): A DIAGNOSIS, NOT A VERDICT

60–75	Strong. Modules 1–4 are secure.	Give the stretch task in every lesson and start nudging toward C2: ask for a more precise word, a second way of saying it, an objection to their own argument. Ask them to chair seminars, to summarize for the group, and to give quieter classmates the first turn.
45–59	On track, with gaps in one or two sections.	Point the learner to the online lessons behind their missed items (use the lesson column above). Recycle those points in warmers.
30–44	Needs targeted support.	A short one-to-one: which part felt hard? Agree on two online lessons to redo with  Listen, usually Lessons 1.2 and 2.1 (or 2.2 if the rewrites were weak). Use the support options in every class. Check attendance and workload.
0–29	Something is getting in the way.	Talk privately and gently. Check vision, hearing, literacy, attendance, and life stress, and whether the learner was placed at the right level. Re-check with the shared placement test ; Confident English (B2) may be a better fit for now. Keep them welcome while you decide together.

Class analysis: add up each section for the whole class and divide by the number of learners. A section average under 60% is a class problem, not an individual one. Build a 5–10 minute recycle into the warmers of Classes 14–19: for example, a "Front it and flip it" relay (neutral → inversion) if rewrites 11, 12, and 17 are weak; a "decide the time of each half" board race if items 6 and 16 are weak; or a "blunt → diplomatic" card swap if rewrite 19 and Reading 8 are weak, which also sets up the seminar skills of Lesson 7.3. Nominalization (rewrite 15) returns naturally in Lessons 5.3 and 6.3.

◆ FINAL TEST (/100): GRADE TO OUTCOME

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Ready for C2	75+ total and Speaking 11+/15 (mostly C1 or C1+ on the rubric), with Writing 18+/30.	Recommend Mastery English (C2 Proficiency) , free online at rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/ . Learners at 90+ with Speaking 13+ are strong C1+ and can move quickly through the first C2 module; tell them so.
C2 with a review plan	60–74 total with Speaking 9+, or 75+ with Speaking 9–10 or Writing under 18/30.	Move on to C2 with a written review plan : the 3–4 C1 online lessons behind their weakest items (see the lesson columns), done with  Listen before C2 Week 3. Lessons 1.3, 2.1, 5.2, and 6.2 are the usual ones; add 8.2 if the writing was padded. Speaking 9–10 learners also benefit from a discussion group or a regular presentation slot.

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Repeat C1 with support	Below 60 total, or Speaking 8 or below .	Recommend a second lap of C1, framed as consolidation and not failure ("The second time, these structures will stop being things you choose and start being things you simply use."). Add a writing partner, a conversation group, or a volunteer tutor if your program has them. If the score was very low, re-check with the shared placement test.
Literacy pathway	Speaking 11+ and Listening 11+/15 , but Reading + Writing under 27/45 .	Oral English is ready for C2 and literacy is the barrier. Don't hold them back for literacy alone. Recommend C2 plus an academic-writing class, a writing center, or a tutor, and ask whether a reading difficulty has ever been assessed. If C2 can't support them, repeat C1 with a writing focus and say clearly why.
Specialist tracks	Any learner with a clear exam or workplace goal, usually 60+ total.	IELTS Academic Preparation (rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/) for learners who need a test score for university admission, professional registration, or immigration. Business English (rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/) for learners whose next step is meetings, negotiation, and professional writing. Both can run alongside C2 or instead of it, depending on the learner's goal and time.

A NOTE ON IELTS EQUIVALENCE (APPROXIMATE ONLY)

Learners will ask, "What IELTS band is this?" Answer honestly: **as a rough guide only**, a secure C1 corresponds to about **IELTS 7.0–8.0**, and C2 to about 8.5–9 (published tables differ slightly at the boundaries; the B2 kit gives about 5.5–6.5 for a secure B2, and Lesson 4.3 of the online course gives the same C1 range). These are broad, published alignments, **not a conversion of this test's score**. No classroom test can predict an official band, and IELTS rewards exam technique and timing that this course doesn't train. A learner who needs a specific band, especially 7.5+ in Writing, should take the IELTS track and at least one full practice test before booking the real exam.

These are **guidelines**. Your thirteen weeks of observation count as much as one test on one day, especially the Class 12 and Class 25 review projects: a learner who wrote and defended a strong position paper yesterday has shown you exactly what C1 looks like. A learner who was ill, anxious, or grieving on test day deserves a re-test or a quick re-check with the shared placement test before any "repeat" recommendation. Record the outcome and a one-line reason for your program.

GIVING FEEDBACK KINDLY

◆ PRINCIPLES

- ◆ **Private, always.** Never read scores aloud or return papers in score order.

◆ PHRASES THAT WORK AT C1

You did an excellent job.

- ◆ **Strength first, then one next step.** One concrete step, not a list of errors.
- ◆ **Name the progress.** Compare with Week 1, not with classmates.
- ◆ **Accuracy, range, and appropriacy.** At C1, the most useful feedback is often about choice, not correctness: "That was grammatical, but *commence* sounded stiff in a message to a friend. Would *start* fit better?"
- ◆ **Respect the professional.** Many C1 learners are experts in their own fields. Frame feedback as one expert to another, and ask what *they* noticed first.
- ◆ **Written note to take home,** with the lesson number and URL.
- ◆ **Adults decide.** Offer the recommendation and the reason, and let the learner choose when the program allows it.

The way you conceded that point and then held your ground was genuinely impressive.

Your thesis was sharp: I knew exactly where you stood by the second sentence.

Your hedging was spot on: strong where the evidence was strong.

Next step: watch the dangling participles. Ask "Who is doing this?" after every opening *-ing*.

Do Lesson 5.2 again at home and keep adding to your preposition chunk list.

Your next class: Mastery English (C2).

One more lap of C1. This time it'll feel like refining, not learning.

I've really enjoyed teaching you.

SAY: *Thirteen weeks ago we were placing events in the future. Yesterday you defended a position paper under questioning.*

SAY: *Your speaking is ready for C2. Your writing needs a little more time, so let's find a writing partner or a writing center to go with it.*

AVOID

Red ink everywhere, percentages without meaning ("68%"), the word "fail", comparisons ("Ana got 92"), and correcting a learner's accent as though it were an error: at C1, clarity comes from prosody, not from sounding "native". Don't grade opinions: a learner who argues the opposite of your view, clearly and politely, or who argued an assigned side, has done exactly what C1 asks. High-achieving adults can take a "repeat" recommendation hard; if a learner goes quiet or gets upset, pause the conversation and come back to it. The number can wait.